

Nintendo Labo

While the console wars head towards Virtual Reality and 4K graphics and next-gen realism, Nintendo has decided to compete using... cardboard. Count on Nintendo to come up with the most innovative(?) way to wow (confuse) the masses. While everyone was expecting Nintendo to announce something huge, they dropped this bomb: The Nintendo Labo. Actually, let's be honest, this is pretty huge too. Sure, not in the way anybody was expecting, but still.

Incase you haven't watched the video, go to <http://dgit.in/2DygZGe> to watch it now.

When we first saw the video we definitely suddenly had the urge to play with cardboard boxes as well. And from the looks from it, it definitely looks like there are several use cases for the Nintendo Labo, some of the stuff in the video did look a tad



complicated to craft but Nintendo has said that the Nintendo Labo is aimed at kids. And of course, adults who are kids at heart. Namely, us!

All of us here at the labs are probably kids at heart too then, since we were pretty excited when Nintendo announced it. Your move Sony and Microsoft.



Hyperkin Ultra Game Boy

After first introducing the SmartBoy accessory to the world as a joke, Hyperkin went ahead and actually released the SmartBoy to the world, which was basically an Android phone sleeve which had authentic Game Boy controls on it and had actual cartridge support for smartphone based Game Boy emulators. However, it was quite silly and limiting.

To that end, Hyperkin are working on project Ultra GB which they plan to release later this year. We got a first look at it during CES and we're glad to say that it still looks like the good old Game Boy. The control layout and design are still the same. The only thing Hyperkin says they're planning to upgrade is the audio-out. The device will have a USB-C charging part in addition to the old-school AC port. The display will also be much better with the option to cycle through colour options on an RGB wheel. Hyperkin says you can expect the device to cost less than \$100.

ElliQ

ElliQ is a smart robot and personal assistant aimed at assisting the elderly. It can do things most smart home assistants in the can market can do right now and more. Features include being able to play music, send and receive messages, manage and organise your calendar and even play videos.

Intuition Robotics ElliQ also has something of a personality to it. As it was intended primarily for the elderly, it can even serve as a companion to have social interactions with.

ElliQ's body has two parts, the base and the "head" which can swivel around and face whichever direction its sensors detect voice coming from. It also features a removable tablet and cameras.

Responding to the phrase "Ellie Q", it can be asked to read out messages and even display attachments that have been sent via messaging services. Additionally, it's also equipped with games, it can detect lack of activity and can suggest activities. ElliQ has Harmon Kardon speakers built into it, which is quality sound. Even the mics can pick up voice from across the room. It's expected to be available later this year.

